

SERIES — STEP 3:

CREATE YOUR CHARACTERS

At this step of the series setup session, each player will create their own *:Otherscape* character, while the MC supports them, asks guiding questions, and makes sure she understands the tags the players are choosing.

See **Character Creation**, starting on page 174.

SERIES — STEP 4:

PICK A CREW THEME

The crew is represented by a **crew theme**, the shared resources and beliefs of the crew, as well as its weaknesses. It is built like all themes: three power tags, one weakness tag, and an Identity, Ritual, or Itch – a single statement or goal that encapsulates the crew's driving motivation or supernatural duty.

⚡ RAPID CREW CREATION

Pick the crew theme kit on pages 156-157 which matches your chosen crew concept and create the theme as a group, using the same guidelines given in **Create Themes From Theme Kits**, page 177.

🔧 CUSTOM CREW CREATION

If you have the time and the inclination to customize every part of your crew, you can create it from scratch by answering the questions in the crew themebook on the next page. For guidelines on custom theme creation see **Answer Themebook Questions**, page 190.

UNITED BY AN IDENTITY, RITUAL, OR ITCH

Each crew has an Identity, Ritual, or Itch which is the glue that binds these people together, the reason for why they are operating as a crew. In a way, it is the boiled down version of the series concept, such as a question all crew members are trying to answer together or a conviction all crew members share.

The group can choose whether to phrase this core aspect as an Identity, Ritual, or Itch. It is essential that not only the players but also the characters they portray agree with this agenda, even if it is an unspoken agreement.

For example, if a group playing a crew of tech mongers chooses the Identity “Someone might as well scavenge what the corporations don’t want anymore”, all crew members should conform to this statement at least to some extent. If a team of ghost hunters feels compelled to fulfill the statement “We must put ghosts to rest peacefully if we can”, and chooses this need as their Ritual, it means everyone agrees that this supernatural demand is the most important thing, for now.

Remember, the characters start the game already knowing each other and have worked with each other for a while, at least long enough to have a joint purpose. This is not to say all members completely agree on what drives the crew but simply that for the time being they agree to set aside any qualms they might have. During the game, the crew theme can mark Decay and be replaced just like any other theme (see **The Crew Theme**, page 75).

THE CREW

CONCEPT

As a group, review the concept of your crew and the series concept you all agreed upon. Flesh it out together by thinking about the following questions:

- ? What is our shared goal?
- ? Who or what brought us together?
- ? Why do we work together? What does each member contribute to the cause?
- ? Who is backing our efforts or giving us jobs?
- ? Where do we meet? Where do we stash our gear or convene in cyberspace?
- ? What sort of resources do we have at our disposal?

POWER TAG QUESTIONS

- A Who are you, as a crew?**
- B Where do you meet, work, rest, or prepare for action?**
- C What activity have you learned to do well together?**
- D Who is guiding, backing, or assisting your operation?**
- E How do you get around?**
- F What environments or situations are you most comfortable in?**
- G What special sources of information do you have?**
- H What sort of reputation or name have you made for yourselves?**
- I How do you help, assist, or support one another?**
- J What kind of special gear, resource, or power is at your disposal?**

WEAKNESS TAG QUESTIONS

- A What is flawed or lacking in the way you operate together?**
- B How do you get each other into trouble?**
- C Who or what are you all afraid of?**
- D What places or situations do you find tough to handle?**

IDENTITY, RITUAL, OR ITCH

Choose an Identity, Ritual, or Itch for this theme: a shared conviction, a magical commitment, or a technological impulse that you all abide by. For example:

- Identity: [Counterculture trendsetters] "If it ain't *xe-non*, man, it ain't worth doing."
- Ritual: [Badlands scavenger cultists] "We must sate Shezmu's thirst."
- Itch: [Forecasting supercomputer tech team] "Predict every obstacle."
- You can try exploring the following options:
 - A belief or goal that unites you all
 - The requirements of a Source you all are fascinated with
 - The impulse of technology that you are all involved with

If any of you is acting in conflict with this statement, this means your crew is beginning to fall apart (see **The Crew Theme**, page 75) and that what previously kept you together may no longer hold true for everyone. Together, decide what could constitute acting against this motivation.

CREW THEME SPECIALS

- ☐ **Huddle:** Once per session, one of the crew members can take an action that affects one target and apply it to the whole crew, ignoring the crew's Scale of 1.
- ☐ **Last Second Leap:** Once per session, when a PC misses a roll, another PC can jump in to help at the last second, if they are capable of doing so. The roll is treated as a mixed hit (7-9), and the helper PC suffers the same Consequences as the PC in the spotlight. Both players can **Mitigate** as usual.
- ☐ **Sacrifice:** When two or more of you face the same Consequences, any player whose PC can reasonably defend another PC may spend any or all of their mitigation Power on mitigating that PC's Consequences instead of their own.
- ☐ **Strong Bonds:** During downtime, when a crew member spend Power on creating relationship story tags representing bonds with other crew members, they get 1 extra Power to spend.
- ☐ **United By The Cause:** During **Credit Roll**, if the entire crew cooperated in a single scene while aligned with this theme's motivation, remove one Decay from this theme.

THEME KITS

ALL-AROUND FIXERS

CREW THEME



POWER TAGS

ALL-AROUND FIXERS

MINERVA'S DINER

IDENTIFYING SUPERNATURAL INTRUSIONS

POWERFUL CLIENTS NONDESCRIPT SEDAN

TENSE NEGOTIATIONS

THE EXCLUSIVE FIXER-ONLY VR DOMAIN

PROBLEM SOLVERS EVERYONE KNOWS THEIR JOB

SPECTRAL AMMUNITION

WEAKNESS TAGS

ARGUMENTATIVE OVERLY CURIOUS

METRO POLICE DETECTIVE UNIT UNDERCITY DEPTHS

IDENTITY

Problems should be solved with minimal blowback.

ELITE SPECIALISTS

CREW THEME



POWER TAGS

ELITE SPECIALISTS

SECURE APARTMENT BASE

INFILTRATION/EXFILTRATION

OUR HANDLER IN A SUIT HAWK-2 VTOL FLIER

GUNNING FOR GUNFIGHTS OLD MILITARY CONTACTS

BEST OF THE BEST FOLLOW THE LEADER

FAVORS FROM PAST CLIENTS

WEAKNESS TAGS

OVERCONFIDENCE TOO QUICK TO ACT

FAILING CORE OBJECTIVE FANCY PARTIES

IDENTITY

Do the job, no questions asked.

COMMUNITY PROTECTORS

CREW THEME



POWER TAGS

COMMUNITY PROTECTORS

BUSH ST. LIBRARY PATROL THESE STREETS

THE PEOPLE WHO LIVE HERE

KNOW THE BACK ALLEYS BY HEART HOME TURF

NOSEY NEIGHBORS PILLARS OF THE COMMUNITY

DIPLOMACY FIRST BORROWED EQUIPMENT

WEAKNESS TAGS

SMALL SCALE OPERATION LOCAL RIVALRIES

LETTING DOWN THE COMMUNITY

THE NATIONAL STAGE

IDENTITY

It's up to us to protect the neighborhood and its people.

FOUND FAMILY

CREW THEME



POWER TAGS

FOUND FAMILY

OUR SHARED APARTMENT BASE

HANDLE EVERYDAY ISSUES

FRIENDS AND COLLEAGUES

A CONVERTED ARMY VAN THINKING ON THE SPOT

HEARD IT THROUGH THE GRAPEVINE

THEY WON'T SEE THIS COMING I'M HERE FOR YOU

PILE OF MEMENTOS FROM PREVIOUS JOBS

WEAKNESS TAGS

NO COMMON BACKGROUND FAR TOO SPONTANEOUS

OLD TROUBLE COME BACK TO BITE YOU BEING APART

IDENTITY

We're in this together.

REBELLIOUS STREET GANG

CREW THEME



POWER TAGS

REBELLIOUS STREET GANG

SEEDY BAR | MARK OUR TERRITORY

UNDERWORLD SUPPLIERS | SOUPED UP VEHICLES

GANG-CONTROLLED AREA | WORD ON THE STREET

AMBITIOUS GANGSTERS | GANG PRIDE

ILLEGAL WEAPONS

WEAKNESS TAGS

TERRITORIAL | EVERYONE THINKS THEY'RE THE BOSS

OUT OF OUR LEAGUE

WRATH OF UNDERWORLD BOSSES

IDENTITY

Dominate the streets or be dominated by others.

SOURCE-HUNTING PRIVATEERS

CREW THEME



POWER TAGS

SOURCE-HUNTING PRIVATEERS

CONVERTED CARGO FREIGHTER

TAKE DOWN CONJURATIONS

LOCAL CONTACTS & GUIDES | BUSHWHACKING

HUNTING DOWN A SOURCE | ANTIQUITIES DATABASES

DARING | HAGGLE OUR WAY OUT OF IT

MAGIC CONTAINMENT BOX

WEAKNESS TAGS

INDIVIDUAL AMBITIONS

I THINK I JUST STEPPED ON A PRESSURE PLATE

CURSES | FIREFIGHTS VS SUPERIOR FOES

IDENTITY

Get the Source, get paid!

SOURCE CABAL

CREW THEME



POWER TAGS

SOURCE CABAL

FORGOTTEN TEMPLE | RESEARCHING MYTHOI

GUIDANCE OF A DEITY | FLIGHT-BESTOWING SOURCE

ENCOUNTERS WITH GODS

COMMUNE WITH THE BEYOND

PROTECTORS OF RELICS | COLLECTION OF SOURCES

BLESSING OF THE SOURCE

WEAKNESS TAGS

POWER HUNGRY | DISTRACTED BY OLD THINGS

SOURCE-SNUFFING MAGIC | NOISE-RIDDEN PLACES

IDENTITY

We must follow the tenets of our Source(s).

WANTED

CREW THEME



POWER TAGS

WANTED

FIND TEMPORARY ACCOMMODATION

BUILD MAKESHIFT WEAPONS

ENEMIES OF OUR ENEMIES | PUBLIC TRANSPORT

ESCAPE PLANS | STOLEN DATABASES | ELUSIVE

VIGILANT | COUNTERFEIT IDs

WEAKNESS TAGS

ALWAYS ON THE MOVE

NO SECURE CHANNEL OF COMMUNICATION

THE AUTHORITIES | PHYSICAL RESTRAINTS

IDENTITY

Never. Get. Caught.